

Braves Aim to Give Fans Fun at the Old Ball Park

Having fun at the old ball park won't be just a matter of chance in Eau Claire's 25th Northern League season.

The Eau Claire Braves' opener with Winnipeg Sunday at 2:30 p. m. brings into focus activities carried on for months to justify the slogan, "It's Fun to Be a Fan."

The opposing teams are products of farm system baseball put together in six weeks of intensive spring training in the Southland. The players are picked from among the best young prospects in the nation.

Carson Park, home field of Eau Claire teams for more than 20 years, is city-owned and regulated but equipped to a considerable degree by professional baseball.

The Eau Claire club itself is a joint venture of baseball-minded local citizens and pro baseball's most interesting team, the Milwaukee Braves.

IF YOU enjoy Sunday's opener and other games during the season, it was planned that way.

The ticket or button which passes you through the turnstile is one of many whose slate provides the money needed to keep baseball going here.

The colorful scorebook which gives you lineups and information about the team and league is a \$12,500 project subscribed by businesses and industries backing baseball here.

The peanuts and pop you enjoy at the game are items from a well-organized concession stand whose revenue helps pay the bills of pro ball.

THE SCOREBOARD in right-center field will have a new look this summer. A huge laughing Indian, symbol of Braves' pennant winners, has been painted by Shelter for the Handicapped to add color.

A new portrait of Andy Cohen, manager of Eau Claire's 1949 champions, hangs in the grandstand lobby Hall of Fame. It joins those of Hank Majeski, Billy Bruton, Wes Westrum, Herman White, Andy Pafko, and Henry Aaron.

A "Fan of the Night" will be honored at each game with red-carpet treatment as special guest of the Braves. He'll watch the game from a rooftop box.

A special promotion is planned for each home stand. Among them will be Regis Day, McDonnell Night, Dairy Night, Babe Ruth and Little League Nights and Barnyard Night.



INDIAN GOES UP — A huge laughing Indian, symbol of Braves pennant winners, is mounted atop the scoreboard at Carson Park in preparation for the Northern League opener Sunday at 2:30 p.m. Securing the Indian are Harlow Westphal (left) and Ed Welke, who serve as city park maintenance men.

EXTRA INTEREST is being added by the "Best of the Braves" contest staged by The Eau Claire Leader and The Daily Telegram to pick the top performer in the all-time, all-star team of Eau Claire players.

Outstanding players of 1960 will be honored in a "Player of the Month" ballot to pick the top performer in the league for each of the four months of the season.

Young Eau Claire fans will be able to see 16 Monday and Wednesday games during the season by paying 25 cents to join the Papoose Club. Memberships for boys and girls 15 and under are available at the YMCA.

Adult fans, spurred by summer-like weather, are buying many books of 12 tickets for \$5, an average cost of 42 cents, available only until May 25.

THE 20-PAGE scorebook full of baseball information and messages is the culmination of six months of work by a committee headed by Frank Golle, Arne Carlson and Bob

to Be a Fan" by means of poster and pocket schedules, napkins and placemats, and stickers featuring the little man with the baseball head used everywhere to publicize pro ball.

Bill Steinecke, Eau Claire's aggressive new manager, has spent nearly two months at Waycross, Ga., picking a team from among Milwaukee's top young prospects.

He's enroute home with an 18-player squad which he terms speedy afoot, adequate in power and promising in pitchers. It includes Eau Claire's Hud Gelein and three other Wisconsin players.

QUINN, in his second year as business manager, has moved into the Carson Park offices for the final hectic week preceding opening day. He's wrapping up the many details required to make for smooth operations.

A new ice-making machine and freezer installed in the concession stand will provide snow cones for warm-weather refreshments.